

Apparently, running AI models locally negates most of the environmental impact.

Posted by u/InfinitesimalInfinity • 0 points • 32 comments

>"Using machine learning algorithms like this is also very efficient and has little to no environmental impact because it can be run locally and has its data kept in the users computers"

Comments

u/Jealous_Piece_1703 • 3 points • 2026-01-29 10:27 UTC

Hello, AI bro here, hope you don't mind explain this (I am not here to argue I am here to explain what Local AI use in term of power)

Not all models are made the same, I have a very good pc, 4090, i9-13900KF, and 128GB RAM, when I use a local model such as SDXL, Llama 7B and GPT OSS 20b. My pc as a whole drain less power than when I am playing PEAK with friends or Fortnite. In fact playing cyberpunk will drain almost as twice as those models. However huge models which need to constantly swap between disk, RAM, and VRAM will push my pc to the limit and max the power usage.

Now when someone say using AI locally use less energy than when using it from huge service with huge datacenter is both correct and wrong.

OpenAI ChatGPT model for example is so huge I will probably need 10 times of my pc just to run one instance of ChatGPT and if somehow I had 10 of my pc I will actually use more power than OpenAI servers as OpenAI servers are made efficient to draw less power and use more efficient cooling methods and GPUs.

However if I am doing it locally I am using a much smaller model and it will actually use way less power.

Thanks for listening.

u/shouldworknotbehere • 1 points • 2026-01-27 13:32 UTC

It's not totally wrong. An Air-cooled PC you built yourself won't gobble up water and make it unusable. A 1kW PC isn't going to blow the power grid up.

It didn't have "no impact", it has about as much environmental impact as using that same PC for gaming or traditional 3D art. Unless they're using a fucking home server with 4 5090s then that isn't true either.

There it comes down to whether the power grid is renewable or not.

But as others pointed out, the people who say that usually don't run them locally.

u/Normtrooper43 • 2 points • 2026-01-26 06:31 UTC

This is like me saying that me flying 100 times a year on a commercial airline, negates most of the damage of the general airline industry.

I'm not operating a private jet, but the problem still remains.

u/Misubi_Bluth • 2 points • 2026-01-26 04:39 UTC

How many people who make this argument know how to do that? And how does that erase the giant data centers in Texas that are negatively impacting people NOW.

u/snek_kogae • 2 points • 2026-01-26 04:01 UTC

Oh it's a sad time to try and base your positions on accuracy and critical thinking

u/treeckosan • 2 points • 2026-01-26 01:08 UTC

I'm curious, even when running these locally are you not still using the training data generated and stored in the data centers? Just cuz your query or prompt is being calculated and the output generated locally training data was generated at the data centers? Unless you just have the raw untrained model but even then that untrained model was built and perfected with the problematic data and data centers?

Or are they talking about hosting their own homemade/open-source models trained only on their own data?

The difference would matter I think.

u/CivilPerspective5804 • 1 points • 2026-01-26 08:23 UTC

What would be a raw untrained model? You don't have a model until you train it

u/CBrinson • 1 points • 2026-01-26 02:21 UTC

aAI the training data is local in the sense you have it all on your computer and don't use a datacenter. There is a website called hugging face which has precollected datasets. You can also train it locally off your own data. It wouldn't impact the environmental friendliness through whether the data is yours or from the sample. Would still use the same power, water etc

You can see Nvidia 's sample data here

<https://huggingface.co/datasets/nvidia/Llama-Nemotron-Post-Training-Dataset>